

BCBS AR Case Manager FAQ

Common questions from the field

Can I share the provider's phone number with a member?

Yes — once the referral reaches **Accepted By Provider** status. Before that point, the link may be visible in Benefits Hub, but the contact details aren't ready to hand out yet.

A member's authorization shows Remaining as 0.00, but I thought they still had hours left. What happened?

Remaining is calculated as **Plan Allowance minus Used minus Pending**. Pending hours count against the balance even before they're finalized, so Remaining can hit zero before a member has actually received all their care.

A member only needs one of the two services. Is that a problem?

No — not every member uses both Post-Discharge and Virtual Companion. It's completely normal for a member to have only one service referral, or none at all if a case manager hasn't created one yet.

A member calls their benefit their “Walmart benefit.” What do I do?

Recognize the reference — some members know this program informally that way — but keep your documentation and Benefits Hub entries in the approved formal program language.

Where do I find the phone number and quantity confirmation a case manager entered on a referral?

Select **View** → **View SDQ** on the referral row. The Service Detail Questions modal shows the best phone number on file and the quantity-allotted confirmation.

Why don't I see an encounter on a brand-new referral?

Encounters only appear after the provider has actioned the referral. A referral with no encounters yet isn't necessarily a problem — it just means the provider hasn't logged a visit.

Do I need to submit a separate escalation or grievance form?

No. BCBS AR routes every issue — from routine questions to stuck referrals — through the one Submit a Request form at bcbsar-thb.zendesk.com. Choose the Issue Type that best fits and include full details in Additional Comments.

What if a required ticket field doesn't apply to my situation?

Enter **N/A** rather than leaving it blank. Every field marked with an asterisk is required, and an empty required field can stall the ticket.

I'm searching by ID and getting no results. Now what?

Use **Advanced Search** to look the member up by First Name, Last Name, and Date of Birth instead. Also double check you're using the care recipient's own ID, not the employee's, if they're a dependent.